Star Tile Studio: My App Guide

Nov 9, 2026 · @Cat

My links

These three links are all you need. Bookmark them.

What	Link	What it's for
Tile maker website	Open the tile maker	Design tiles and save them as pictures. Works on any phone or computer. Only I can see it until I press Share.
Download the iPhone app code	Download the zip file	Open this on my Mac to get the newest version of the app. Download it again every time Claude says there is an update.
Where the code is stored	GitHub folder	The online storage for everything Claude builds. The word "effortless" is just the storage folder's name.

What I have so far

I have a working tile maker website, and the first screen of a real iPhone app that hasn't been tried on my Mac yet.

Tile maker website (works now)

- 8 star patterns: Octagon, Double octagon, Square & triangle, Square, Diamond, Cairo, Triangle fan, Diagonal fan
- 7 ready-made designs, plus a Surprise me button
- 7 colour sets: Lisbon blue, Azulejo, Talavera, Fez green, Seville, Puebla pink, Midnight gold. I can also change any single colour.
- Sliders for star points, gap between stars, line thickness and patterns per tile
- Extras: inner star, dots, star on tile corners, double lines
- Wall preview with grout lines and glaze shine
- Save buttons: **Save in colour** and **Save black and white outline**, up to 4096 pixels

iPhone app (written, not yet tested)

- Endless wall of tiles: pinch to zoom, drag to move, double-tap to go back to 100%

- Settings panel that slides up from the bottom, at half or full height
- Repeat types: Grid, Brick, Half-drop, Mirror
- Tile size, shift across, shift down and colour turn, each with precise sliders and − / + buttons
- The same 8 patterns and 7 colour sets as the website
- Small vibrations when things snap into place
- Light and dark mode

Not built yet: saving tiles to Photos, a gallery of saved designs, the app icon, a welcome screen, and the paid upgrade.

Road to the App Store

There are 5 steps, and I'm on step 1: getting the app running on my Mac.

1. **Get the app running on my Mac** ← I am here
   - Open the code in Xcode, press ▶, and send Claude a screenshot of what shows up.
   - Claude can't see or press anything on my Mac, so I'm Claude's eyes for this part.
2. **Finish the app** (Claude builds, I test)
   - Save tiles to the phone's Photos
   - A gallery of saved designs
   - App icon and welcome screen
   - The paid upgrade, with a "Restore purchases" button
3. **Join Apple's developer program**
   - Sign up at developer.apple.com. It costs **$99 a year**.
   - Not needed until the app is nearly finished.
4. **Send the app to Apple**
   - Upload from Xcode, then add screenshots, a description and the price in App Store Connect.
   - Apple checks it, usually in 1 to 2 days. Claude will write the description and help with each screen.
5. **Earn money**
   - Apple handles all payments and pays me each month.

How to run the app on my Mac

Do this once to set up, then only Step 1 and Step 4 again for each update.

Step 1: Download the code

1. On the Mac, open the **Download the zip file** link from My links in Safari.
2. Double-click the downloaded file in **Downloads** to unzip it.
3. Open the **ios** folder inside. There is a folder called **StarTileStudio**.

Step 2: Make a new app in Xcode (first time only)

1. Open **Xcode** and choose **File → New → Project**.
2. Pick **iOS** at the top, then **App**, then **Next**.
3. Product Name: `StarTileStudio`. Interface: **SwiftUI**. Language: **Swift**. If it asks for a Team, None is fine.
4. Click **Next**, choose where to save (the Desktop is fine), then **Create**.

Step 3: Swap in Claude's code

1. In Xcode's file list on the left, right-click **ContentView → Delete → Move to Trash**. Do the same for **StarTileStudioApp**.
2. Drag the **StarTileStudio** folder from Downloads onto the top blue item in Xcode's list.
3. Tick **Copy items if needed**, then click **Finish**.
4. Click the blue project icon, then the app under Targets, then **General**. Set **Minimum Deployments** to **iOS 17.0**.

Step 4: Press play

1. At the top of Xcode, pick a pretend iPhone, for example **iPhone 16**.
2. Press the ▶ button and wait about a minute.
3. A pretend iPhone opens with the app. Hold **Option** while dragging to pinch and zoom.

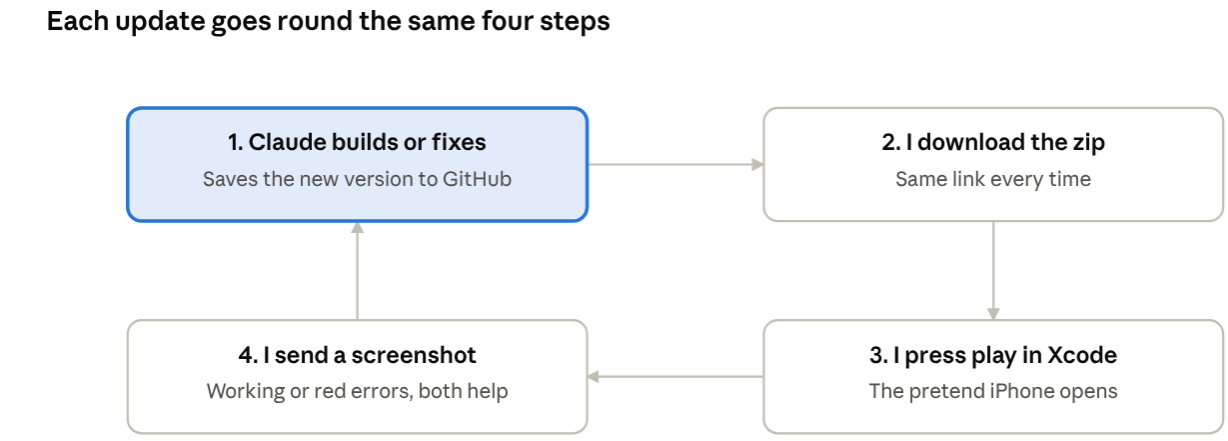
If red errors appear

- Take a screenshot with **Shift + Command + 4** and drag over the errors, then send it to Claude.
- Many errors mentioning "actor" or "Sendable": go to **Build Settings**, search **Swift Language Version**, set it to **Swift 5**, and press ▶ again.

When there is an update: download the zip again, delete the old **StarTileStudio** folder in Xcode (Move to Trash), and drag in the new one.

How Claude and I work together

Claude writes the app, and I'm the one who runs it on my Mac and shows Claude what happens.



how Claude and I work together · 4 steps that repeat

The highlighted step is Claude's; the other three are mine. Claude can't see my Mac, so the screenshot is what keeps things moving.

Making money

The plan is a free download with a one-time upgrade of about **$4.99**, which earns me about **$4.24** per sale after Apple's cut.

A free app with nothing to buy earns nothing. Free to download, with paid extras inside, gets the most people trying it and paying.

Way to earn	How it works	Notes
One-time upgrade (the plan)	Free: a few patterns, a few colour sets, small downloads. Pay once to unlock everything.	Easy to understand. People like paying once.
Subscription	For example $2.99 a month or $19.99 a year	Earns more over time, but people expect new patterns regularly. Could add later.
Adverts	Earn a tiny amount per advert seen	Needs a huge number of users. Makes the app feel cheaper.
Paid download	People pay before downloading, for example $2.99	Far fewer people try it, so it usually earns less.

Apple's cut: Apple keeps **15%** and pays me 85%. The 15% rate is for small businesses earning under $1 million a year, and I have to apply for Apple's Small Business Program to get it. Otherwise Apple keeps 30%.

Getting past Apple's review

Apple doesn't reject apps for their style, but it does reject apps that crash, look unfinished, or seem too basic. A rejection isn't final: Apple says why, we fix it, and I send it again.

Common reason for rejection	How we avoid it
Crashes, or a button that does nothing	Test every button on my iPhone before sending
Too basic ("minimum functionality")	The app is a real design tool with zoom, precise controls and downloads
Looks unfinished: placeholder text, empty screens, "coming soon"	No placeholders left in the version I send
Copies another app	Our patterns and tools are our own
Paid upgrade breaks Apple's rules	Include a **Restore purchases** button and say clearly what the upgrade unlocks
Missing information	Add a privacy policy and screenshots that match the app

If Apple rejects it: copy Apple's message and send it to Claude to fix.

Design decisions to remember

Star Tile Studio is its own app, separate from Seamlessly Does It, but it borrows the Seamlessly Does It colours and fonts.

Decision	What we chose
App name	Star Tile Studio
Background	Warm off-white (#FBFAF9), near-black in dark mode
Text	Near-black (#121212)
Accent colour	Pink (#FF58AE) for buttons, chosen options and sliders
Heading font	Bricolage Grotesque
Text font	Inter

Decision	What we chose
Look	White cards with soft shadows, rounded pill-shaped buttons
Tile style	Arabic star patterns in Portuguese azulejo and Mexican Talavera colours
Lisbon blue colour set	Uses the brighter cobalt blue from the Azulejo set
Azulejo colour set	Cobalt blue, sunny yellow and sky blue on white, from my reference photo
Cairo pattern	Rebuilt so it sits straight on the tile
Room mock-ups	Removed because they didn't look real
Who it's for	iPhone and iPad, iOS 17 or newer

Words I might hear

Word	What it means
Artifact	A page Claude makes that opens in Claude, like my tile maker website. Private until I press Share.
Claude Code	The Claude that writes code and saves it to GitHub for me.
Code	The written instructions that make an app or website work.
GitHub	Online storage for my code. Claude saves everything there.
Zip file	A squashed folder. Double-click it to open it.
Xcode	Apple's free program on my Mac that turns code into an iPhone app.
Simulator	The pretend iPhone that opens on my Mac screen when I press ▶ in Xcode.
Build / Run	Pressing ▶ in Xcode to turn the code into the app and open it.
Error	A red message in Xcode saying something needs fixing. Normal; send a screenshot to Claude.

Word	What it means
Apple Developer Program	Apple's $99-a-year membership needed to sell apps.
App Store Connect	Apple's website where I add the app's price, screenshots and description.
App review	Apple checking the app before it goes on the App Store.
In-app purchase	Something people pay for inside the app, like the upgrade.
Seamless tile	A square picture that joins up with no visible edge when repeated.

My to-do list

My one job right now is to get the app open in Xcode and send Claude a screenshot.

- [ ] Download the zip file on my Mac (link in My links)
- [ ] Follow "How to run the app on my Mac", Steps 1 to 4
- [ ] Send Claude a screenshot of what Xcode shows, even if it's red errors
- [ ] Later: decide the upgrade price (suggested $4.99)
- [ ] Later: join the Apple Developer Program ($99 a year), only when the app is nearly finished